JAMES MITCHELL

Software Engineer (Staff Level)

Manchester, United Kingdom

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Experienced Staff Software Engineer with 10 years of progressive development experience across financial services, telecommunications, and cloud infrastructure sectors. Proven track record of designing and delivering large-scale distributed systems, leading technical initiatives, and mentoring junior engineers. Strong expertise in backend architecture, microservices patterns, and system scalability. Based in Manchester with a passion for building maintainable code and fostering collaborative engineering cultures.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Staff Software Engineer

Synapse Data Ltd

Manchester, United Kingdom

synapsedataltd.io

March 2022 - Present

Designed and implemented a real-time event streaming platform handling over 500,000 events per second using Kafka and Apache Flink, serving as the core infrastructure for data analytics across the organization.

Led the architecture review and migration of a monolithic payment processing system to microservices, reducing deployment time by 65% and improving system reliability to 99.98% uptime.

Established coding standards, conducted technical code reviews for a team of 12 engineers, and created comprehensive documentation for system design patterns and deployment procedures.

Mentored four junior developers through promotion pathways, focusing on system design principles, debugging complex distributed system issues, and professional development planning.

Senior Software Engineer

BT Group

Stockport, Greater Manchester, United Kingdom

bt.com

June 2018 - February 2022

Developed and maintained high-availability telecommunications infrastructure services handling 2.3 million concurrent connections across multiple data centres using Java, Spring Boot, and PostgreSQL.

Implemented automated monitoring and alerting systems using Prometheus and Grafana, reducing mean time to resolution for production incidents by 48%.

Collaborated with product and DevOps teams to deliver quarterly releases across 15 microservices while maintaining zero data loss guarantees and backward compatibility.

Contributed to the technical hiring process by conducting 30+ interviews, participating in graduate recruitment programs, and defining competency frameworks for engineering roles.

Software Engineer

NovaTech Solutions Ltd

Manchester, United Kingdom

novatech-solutions.co

August 2014 - May 2018

Built and deployed customer-facing APIs and backend services for a SaaS platform serving healthcare organizations, utilizing Node.js, Express, and MongoDB with 99.5% uptime SLA.

Optimized database query performance and implemented caching strategies that reduced average API response times from 850ms to 120ms, improving user experience metrics by 34%.

Participated in full software development lifecycle from requirements gathering through production deployment, including writing unit tests and integration tests with 78% code coverage.

Supported production systems through on-call rotations and resolved critical security vulnerabilities, including implementing OAuth 2.0 authentication and SSL certificate management.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science in Computer Science

University of Manchester

Manchester, United Kingdom

Graduated: June 2014

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: Java, Python, JavaScript, Go, SQL

Frameworks and Libraries: Spring Boot, Express.js, Django, React

Databases: PostgreSQL, MySQL, MongoDB, Elasticsearch

Cloud Platforms: AWS, Google Cloud Platform

DevOps and Tools: Docker, Kubernetes, Terraform, Jenkins, Git

Messaging and Streaming: Apache Kafka, RabbitMQ, Apache Flink

Monitoring and Observability: Prometheus, Grafana, ELK Stack, Datadog

Architectural Patterns: Microservices, Event-Driven Architecture, CQRS, Domain-Driven Design